

Gábor Békés

Associate Professor, Central European University · Senior Research Fellow, MTA KRTK Institute of Economics

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ORCID: [0000-0002-6331-4408](https://orcid.org/0000-0002-6331-4408)
Google Scholar: 2,361 citations, h-index 21 (Oct 2026)
Born 21 November 1974, Hungarian

Applied economist working on international economics, economic geography and organizations, mostly with large firm-, transaction- and person-level microdata.

POSITIONS

- 2023– Associate Professor, Department of Economics and Business, Central European University, Vienna
- 2017–2023 Assistant Professor, Department of Economics and Business, Central European University
- 2005– Senior Research Fellow, MTA KRTK Institute of Economics, Budapest

Affiliations

- 2022– Research Fellow, CEPR (Research Affiliate 2014–2022)
Research Fellow, Centro Studi Luca d’Agliano (Centro LdA), Italy
- 2025– Advising Fellow, Microsoft AI Economy Institute
Leads the Data Analysis and AI Lab, which supports research, produces education materials and links academia and industry

EDUCATION

- 2007 PhD in Economics, Central European University, Budapest
- 2000 MSc in Economics, London School of Economics
- 1999 BSc in Economics and MSc in Finance and Economics, Corvinus University of Budapest

PUBLICATIONS IN REFEREED JOURNALS

- 2026 [Right-wing terrorism and far-right support: Evidence from anti-Roma attacks in Hungary](#) (with Gábor Simonovits, Attila Gáspár and Márton Végh). *Political Science Research and Methods*, published online 10 August 2026.
- 2025 [Cultural homophily and collaboration in superstar teams](#) (with Gianmarco I.P. Ottaviano). *Management Science* 71(10): 8149–8168.
- 2024 [Favoritism under multiple sources of social pressure](#) (with Endre Borza and Márton Fleck). *Economic Inquiry* 62(4): 1748–1769.
- 2021 [Into the unknown: The extent and boldness of firms’ international footprint](#) (with Davide Castellani, Balázs Muraközy and Gabriel R.G. Benito). *Global Strategy Journal* 11(3): 468–493.
- 2020 [Machine imports, technology adoption and local spillovers](#) (with Péter Harasztosi). *Review of World Economics* 156(2): 343–375.
- 2018 [The ladder of internationalization modes: Evidence from European firms](#) (with Balázs Muraközy). *Review of World Economics* 154(3): 455–491.
- 2018 [Grid and shake: Spatial aggregation and the robustness of regionally estimated elasticities](#) (with Péter Harasztosi). *The Annals of Regional Science* 60(1): 143–170.
- 2017 [Shipment frequency of exporters and demand uncertainty: An inventory management approach](#) (with Lionel Fontagné, Balázs Muraközy and Vincent Vicard). *Review of World Economics* 153(4): 779–807.
- 2016 [Measuring productivity premia with many modes of internationalization](#) (with Balázs Muraközy). *Economics Letters* 139: 61–64.
- 2013 [Internationalization and innovation of firms: Evidence and policy](#) (with Carlo Altomonte, Tommaso Aquilante and Gianmarco I.P. Ottaviano). *Economic Policy* 28(76): 663–700.
- 2013 [Agglomeration premium and trading activity of firms](#) (with Péter Harasztosi). *Regional Science and Urban Economics* 43(1): 51–64.
- 2012 [Temporary trade and heterogeneous firms](#) (with Balázs Muraközy). *Journal of International Economics* 87(2): 232–246.
- 2011 [Firms and products in international trade: Evidence from Hungary](#) (with Balázs Muraközy and Péter Harasztosi). *Economic Systems* 35(1): 4–24.
- 2009 [Spillovers from multinationals to heterogeneous domestic firms: Evidence from Hungary](#) (with Jörn Kleinert and Farid Toubal). *The World Economy* 32(10): 1408–1433.

Beyond economics

- 2020 [Comorbidity clusters in generalized osteoarthritis among female patients: A cross-sectional study](#) (with E. Kővári, A. Kaposi et al.). *Seminars in Arthritis and Rheumatism* 50(2): 183–191.

- 2014 A patient-derived and patient-reported outcome measure for assessing psoriatic arthritis: Elaboration and preliminary validation of the Psoriatic Arthritis Impact of Disease (PsAID) questionnaire, a 13-country EULAR initiative (with L. Gossec, T.K. Kvien et al.). *Annals of the Rheumatic Diseases* 73(6): 1012–1019.

BOOKS AND BOOK CHAPTERS

- 2021 *Data Analysis for Business, Economics, and Policy* (with Gábor Kézdi). Cambridge University Press. Textbook with data and code in R, Python and Stata (gabors-data-analysis.com); used in courses in more than 40 countries.
- 2016 *Measuring competitiveness in Europe: Resource allocation, granularity and trade* (editor, with Carlo Altomonte). Bruegel Blueprint, Brussels. Includes the chapters “Measuring competitiveness in a granular and global world” (with Carlo Altomonte), pp. 3–13, and “Micro-founded measurement of regional competitiveness in Europe” (with Gianmarco I.P. Ottaviano), pp. 26–46.
- 2015 Barriers to data access and matching in Europe (with Zsuzsa Holler). In D. Castellani and A. Koch (eds.), *Mapping competitiveness with European data*, Bruegel Blueprint 23.
- 2011 *Still standing: How European firms weathered the crisis* (with Miklós Koren, László Halpern and Balázs Muraközy). Bruegel Blueprint 15.
- 2004 Motives of corporate location choice. In K. Fazekas, J. Koltay and Zs. Cseres-Gergely (eds.), *The Hungarian labour market 2004*, MTA KTI.

DISCUSSION PAPERS AND WORK IN PROGRESS

- 2026 What happens in Paris, does not stay in Paris: Trade fairs and search and matching frictions (with Claudia Steinwender and Mátyás Molnár). CEPR DP21574.
- 2026 Vibe coding kills open source (with Miklós Koren, Julian Hinz and Aaron Lohmann). CEPR DP21145; arXiv 2601.15494. Covered by the *Financial Times*, TechTarget, InfoQ and others.
- 2025 Stardust: Peer effects in early career development (with Bence Szabó). Working paper.
- 2025 Integrators and robot adoption: Facts from Hungary (with Alessandra Bonfiglioli, Rosario Crinó and Gino Gancia). CEPR DP20026.
- Connected choices: Business group affiliation and FDI location decisions (with Márta Bisztray and Péter Harasztosi). Submitted.
- When dispersed teams are more successful: Theory and evidence from software (with Miklós Koren, Aaron Lohmann and Julian Hinz). Work in progress.
- Supplier–buyer relationships in global value chains (with Balázs Muraközy, Álmos Telegdy and Miklós Koren). Work in progress.

PUBLICATIONS IN HUNGARIAN

- 2020 Területi egyensúly: a munkaerőpiac és az ingatlanárak kapcsolata Magyarországon (with Márta Bisztray). *Sigma* 51(3): 185–214.
- 2016 Lakóingatlanárak és települési különbségek (with Áron Horváth and Zoltán Sági). *Közgazdasági Szemle*.
- 2016 Beszállítói termékek a magyar feldolgozóiparban (with Balázs Muraközy). *Közgazdasági Szemle*.
- 2013 Külkereskedelem és a vállalatok közötti különbségek (with Balázs Muraközy and László Halpern). *Közgazdasági Szemle*.
- 2012 Magyar gazellák: a gyors növekedésű vállalatok jellemzői és kialakulásuk elemzése (with Balázs Muraközy). *Közgazdasági Szemle*.
- 2011 A teremtő rombolás szerepe a vállalati termelékenység alakulásában Magyarországon (with László Halpern and Balázs Muraközy). *Közgazdasági Szemle*.
- 1998 Optimális valutaövezetek, gazdasági integráltság és hasonlatosság: az Európai Unió példája. *Közgazdasági Szemle*.
- 2008, 2011 Book chapters on national innovation systems and on innovation clusters, in two volumes edited by G. Pörzse, Semmelweis Kiadó.

RESEARCH GRANTS

- 2026 FWF–DFG Weave research grant
- 2022–2025 RETHINK-GSC, Horizon Europe (No. 101061123)
- 2015 The location of employment: Migration, housing and concentration, OTKA
- 2013–2015 MapCompete, EU FP7 (lead partner, project manager)
- 2012 Competitiveness Research Network (CompNet), ECB, Banque de France and partners
- 2009–2012 EFIGE: European Firms in a Global Economy, EU FP7
- 2007–2010 Micro-Dyn, EU FP6
- 2006–2007 Factors determining the benefit of spillovers, GDN Regional Research Competition (CERGE-EI)

AWARDS

2013–2016 MTA Bolyai János Research Scholarship; the project received the Bolyai Plaque for best project
2008 OeNB Olga Radzyner Award for scientific work on European economic integration

TEACHING

2013– Data Analysis 1–4, CEU (MA/MS and PhD), a course sequence built on the Békés–Kézdi textbook Data Analysis with AI 1–2, CEU (BA/MA and MA/PhD); [open-access course material](#)
Applied Economics with Sports Data (PhD/Research MA); Prediction and Machine Learning for Economists (PhD/MA); Data-Driven Decision Making (Executive MBA), CEU
2011–2016 Regional and Urban Economics, CEU (MA)
2010–2014 Economic Geography, ELTE, Budapest (BA)
Director (four years) and deputy director (two years) of the MS in Business Analytics programme, CEU

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee Management Science, European Economic Review, Journal of International Economics, International Economic Review, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Review of World Economics, Canadian Journal of Economics, Global Strategy Journal, Journal of Economic Geography, and others
Grants Reviewer for OTKA (Hungary) and for Czech and Belgian research funding agencies
Organizer Data Analytics Jamboree, Vienna, 2024 and 2025
Member European Economic Association; Hungarian Economic Association (MKE)

POLICY WRITING AND MEDIA

VoxEU Columns on trade complexity (2010), European firms in the crisis (2012), temporary trade (2012), internationalisation and innovation (2014), the ladder of internationalisation modes (2018), and technology adoption via machine imports (2019)
Reports EFIGE country report on Hungary (2011); Micro-Dyn policy papers (2010–2011)
Media Research covered by the *Financial Times*, *Boston Globe* and *Der Standard*; interviews in Portfolio, 444 and Telex; podcasts including The Mixtape with Scott Cunningham (2023) and CEU's *Teaching Analytics in the Age of AI* (2026). Full list at gaborbekes.com/popular-press

LANGUAGES AND SCIENTIFIC TOOLS

Languages Hungarian (native), English (fluent), French (good)
Coding Stata, R, some Python
AI Agentic AI tools for research and data analysis